

STORYTIME: Lagos — Game Design Document

Oct 9, 2026 · @Monae

Overview

STORYTIME: Lagos is a web-based narrative choice game in seven playable chapters, one per story in *What Is It About Lagos*, built as a companion to the self-published book.

Pitch. Seven people. One city. Every choice costs you money or costs you yourself. You live each story from inside it, make the choices its hero faced, and discover how the city answers.

Item	Decision
Genre	Narrative choice game (interactive fiction with light management and investigation mechanics per chapter)
Chapters	All 7 stories, playable in book order, linked on one Lagos map
Platform	Web first; installable as a PWA; wrapped for Android and iOS stores later
Build	GitHub repository, built with Claude Code
Audience	Adults (target rating 16+ to 18+); dark canon endings stay playable
Session length	20–40 minutes per chapter; about 4–5 hours for all seven, more with alternate endings
Purpose	Companion and marketing tool for the book: drives readers to the book and rewards book owners
Language	English narration with Nigerian Pidgin dialogue kept as written, plus an in-game glossary

Design pillars.

1. **Naira or Spirit.** Almost every choice trades survival against integrity, the theme every story shares.

2. **Lagos is the antagonist.** The city pushes back through events, people and systems, never through a single villain alone.
3. **The book is canon.** Each chapter's "As Written" ending is the book's ending; alternate endings show the roads the characters did not take.
4. **One city, connected lives.** Characters cross between chapters, and some choices carry forward.
5. **Story, story!** Every chapter is framed as a told story, using the Nigerian call-and-response storytelling ritual.

Content and rating

The dark canon endings stay playable: Mama Ngozi's stabbing, the Isale Eko demolition violence and Ifeoma's disownment are reached through the player's own choices, not skipped or softened.

How dark moments are presented. Violence is written, not shown graphically. Each moment uses text, sound and a still illustration, then a hard cut. The player is never rewarded for cruelty; the game shows consequences, it does not glamorise them.

Chapter	Content notes
The Grind	Extortion, knife violence, serious injury
The Ghost of Marina	Threats to family, implied disappearance, financial crime
The Pastor's Daughter	Same-sex relationship, religious condemnation, family rejection
Danfo Diaries	Police extortion, threatened assault
The Community Defender	Forced eviction, crowd violence, arrests
Roots and Thorns	Corruption, bribery, financial ruin
The Fabric of Dreams	Exploitation, design theft

Player protections that do not remove content.

- A short content note on each chapter card before it starts.
- An optional "pause before intense scenes" setting: a one-tap prompt before the scene plays, then the scene plays in full.
- A help and resources link in the menu.

Rating. Expect a mature rating. Complete each store's age-rating questionnaire (Google Play uses IARC; Apple uses its own age-rating form) when wrapping for app stores. For the web and PWA version, add an age gate on first launch.

Distribution consideration (flagged). *The Pastor's Daughter* depicts a same-sex relationship. Nigeria's Same Sex Marriage (Prohibition) Act 2014 restricts public displays of same-sex relationships, and some app stores apply regional content rules. This already applies to the book itself. Get local legal advice before marketing the game in Nigeria, and decide whether store listings are regional or global.

Core systems

Every chapter runs on two shared meters, Naira and Spirit, plus one meter unique to that chapter, and the city pushes back through a deck of Lagos Factor events.

Shared meters (0–100, shown in every chapter)

Meter	What it means	Rises when	Falls when
Naira	Survival: money, security, safety of the family	You pay, comply, compromise, take the deal	You refuse, resist, walk away
Spirit	Integrity: dignity, honesty, being yourself	You speak the truth, protect others, refuse to bend	You lie, pay a bribe, betray someone, stay silent

The two pull against each other by design. A choice that raises both is rare and should feel earned (usually by help from another character). If either meter reaches 0, the chapter moves to a "broken" ending.

Chapter meters

Chapter	Third meter	Danger at
The Grind	Profit (today's earnings vs the levy)	Below the ₦500 levy at 2 PM
The Ghost of Marina	Watched (how much Akin Bamidele suspects)	100: the threat call comes early
The Pastor's Daughter	Suspicion (how close the family is to the truth)	100: discovered before you choose to tell

Chapter	Third meter	Danger at
Danfo Diaries	Daily target (returns owed to the bus owner)	Under target at day's end
The Community Defender	Morale (how united Isale Eko is)	Below 30: residents take the compensation
Roots and Thorns	Capital (Innovate Africa's runway in weeks)	0: the company folds
The Fabric of Dreams	Vision (how much of Kosi's style survives)	Below 30: the brand loses its voice

Lagos Factor deck

A shared deck of short events the city throws at you between scenes. Each chapter draws from its own pool plus a common pool. Each card offers two or three responses, each moving the meters.

Card	Example responses
NEPA took light	Run the generator (–Naira) · work in the dark (–progress)
Go-slow	Take the long route (–time) · pay an okada (–Naira)
"Settlement" demanded	Pay (–Naira, –Spirit) · argue (risk) · walk away (–progress)
Family needs money	Send it (–Naira, +Spirit) · promise later (–Spirit)
Neighbour asks for help	Help (+Spirit, –time) · decline (no change)
Rain floods the road	Wade through (risk to goods) · wait it out (–time)

The Storytime frame

Each chapter opens with the narrator's call, "Story, story!", and the player taps the response, "Story!" The narrator then says "Once upon a time..." and the player answers "Time, time!" At the end, the narrator closes the tale and gives the **verdict**: what the character kept (Naira, Spirit, both or neither) and which ending was reached. Verdicts fill the Endings gallery.

Structure

The player moves between chapters on an illustrated Lagos map; chapters play in book order on a first run, and each finished chapter unlocks the next and its map location.

The Lagos map hub

An illustrated map of Lagos with seven pins. Each pin shows the chapter card: title, protagonist, location, content note, endings found (for example, 2 of 4) and a Play button. Completed chapters glow; locked ones show only a silhouette and "Story, story...".

#	Chapter	Protagonist	Map location	Story time (relative)	Endings
1	The Grind	Mama Ngozi	Mushin to Oshodi	Year 0	4
2	The Ghost of Marina	Tunde Adedapo	Marina, Lagos Island	Undated	4
3	The Pastor's Daughter	Ifeoma Mbah	Ikoyi and Yaba	Undated	4
4	Danfo Diaries	Dele	Agege to CMS	Year 0, months later	4
5	The Community Defender	Mama Peju	Isale Eko	Undated	3
6	Roots and Thorns	Emeka	Yaba and Apapa	Year 15	4
7	The Fabric of Dreams	Kosi	Surulere	Undated	4

The timeline column follows the revised manuscript: Emeka is 15 in *The Grind* and 30 in *Roots and Thorns*. Chapters marked "Undated" have no fixed year in the book; the game does not invent one.

Unlocks and replay

- **First run:** chapters unlock in book order.
- **After finishing a chapter:** it can be replayed from the map at any time to find other endings.
- **After finishing all seven:** a free-play mode opens every chapter, and the "Lagos Remembers" epilogue plays (a short narrated scene that reflects the player's verdicts across all seven stories).

Endings model

Every chapter has one **As Written** ending (the book's ending, marked with a book icon) and two or three alternate endings. Endings are decided by meter values plus key-choice flags at the chapter's final decision. The Endings gallery shows each ending's title and verdict once found, and a locked card with a one-line hint for those not found.

Chapter designs

Each chapter follows its story's beats, gives the player the decisions its hero faced, and ends in the book's ending or one of two or three alternates. Every alternate ending is new writing proposed here and needs your approval before it is scripted.

1. The Grind — Mama Ngozi

A single working day, 3:45 AM to 2:15 PM, played as time management with one deadly confrontation at the end.

Loop. A clock runs through five phases: prepare (grind beans, fry batches; bigger batches mean more profit and more fatigue), commute (danfo to Oshodi plus a Lagos Factor card), morning rush (serve customers and make change), Jagaban's 10 AM visit, and the afternoon (talk to Aisha, Old Madam and other traders before 2 PM).

Key decisions.

1. How many batches to fry, which sets Profit and fatigue.
2. Whether to help the traders Jagaban targets (the tailor, the okra seller), which builds Solidarity but costs selling time.
3. What to tell Chidinma when she calls about JAMB money.
4. At 2:15 PM: pay the ₦500, stand on dignity, rally the traders, or leave for Mile 12.

Ending	Reached by	Verdict
As Written: The Akara on the Ground	Refuses with dignity, little Solidarity	Kept Spirit, lost everything else; she collapses (survival is revealed in Danfo Diaries)
Paid in Full	Pays the ₦500	Kept her body, lost Chidinma's JAMB money and her pride
Mile 12	Leaves before 2 PM	Kept safety, lost her customers and her spot
The Market Stands	Rallies traders after helping at least three of them	Kept both, for today; Jagaban promises to return

2. The Ghost of Marina — Tunde Adedapo

An investigation chapter: dig into Victor's disappearance while Akin Bamidele watches you dig.

Loop. Office days alternate with evenings. In the office you handle accounts, search for clues and answer Akin's questions; each discovery raises Watched. Evenings are for Lara, Bayo and decoding the ledger. Lies to Akin lower Watched but cost Spirit.

Key decisions and puzzles.

1. Search Victor's desk (a hidden-object scene that finds the taped USB stick).
2. Crack the password from clues about Victor's habits (dates fail; "Integrity" works).
3. Read the ledger: match approvals, shell companies and recipient aliases.
4. Respond to Akin's HR file and the photo of Victor's sister: comply, deflect or push back.
5. Final choice: send the anonymous report abroad, stay silent, confront Akin, or flee with Lara.

Ending	Reached by	Verdict
As Written: Lagos Hears Everything	Sends the report	Kept Spirit; alive, free and hunted
The Golden Cage	Stays silent	Kept Naira and a promotion; Segun walks into Victor's trap
Discredited	Confronts Akin directly	Lost both; a fabricated HR file ends his career
Far from Marina	Flees with Lara	Kept his life, left his parents within reach of the threat

3. The Pastor's Daughter — Ifeoma Mbah

A double-life chapter: keep the perfect daughter's mask in place while becoming who you are.

Loop. A weekly cycle: Sunday service (lead worship, greet Brother Daniel), weekday family scenes (Mummy G.O. Norma Mbah's pressure, Pastor Okechukwu Mbah's sermons), and Tuesday at The Canvas with Sade. Time at The Canvas raises Spirit and Suspicion together; family duties lower Suspicion and cost Spirit.

Key decisions.

1. How to answer each "Have you prayed about Daniel?"
2. How far to let the relationship with Sade go, and what to tell her about the family.
3. In Papa's study, "Any reservations?": lie (as written) or tell the truth early.
4. At the dressing table on thanksgiving morning: tell Mummy, go through with it, leave quietly, or speak to the congregation.

Ending	Reached by	Verdict
As Written: Her Own Kind of Salvation	Tells Mummy on thanksgiving morning	Kept Spirit; disowned, moves to Surulere
Gold Lace	Goes through with the thanksgiving	Kept her family and comfort, lost herself
The Quiet Door	Leaves a letter and goes before the service	Kept Spirit, with less public fallout and a door left ajar
From the Pulpit	Speaks to the congregation	Kept Spirit at the highest cost; the church turns on her publicly

4. Danfo Diaries — Dele

A route-running chapter over four working days, Monday to Thursday, ending at Iddo.

Loop. Each day: call passengers in the park, collect fares and make change fast, then pick route segments (Fadeyi, Obalende, Costain, Iddo). Each segment carries a chance of Officer Bala. In each Bala encounter you pay, plead, argue or flee. Kunle drives; his trust rises when you are careful and falls when you take risks.

Key decisions.

1. Detour around Bala (safer, costs fuel and time) or keep the direct route.
2. Pay, plead, argue or flee in each encounter.
3. What to tell Bola about the missing money.
4. Thursday at Iddo: pay the ₦10,000 or defy Bala.

Ending	Reached by	Verdict
As Written: His Own Man	Defies Bala with the crowd behind him	Kept Spirit, lost some Naira; Bala swears revenge
Empty Hands	Pays the ₦10,000	Kept the bus, went home with nothing
Impounded	Defies Bala without the crowd's support	Lost the bus for days; Dele and Kunle owe the owner
The Long Way Round	Avoids Bala all week	Kept the peace, lost income to detours; nothing changes

5. The Community Defender — Mama Peju

A seven-day coalition strategy chapter, from the demolition notice to the bulldozers.

Loop. Each day, Mama Peju spends three actions: visit families, hold a meeting under the Iroko tree, work with the lawyer Mr. Adebayo, run social media with the young women, set scouts with the young men, pool money, or negotiate. Each night brings an escalation card (power cut, water cut, arrests, a threat against her son). Morale is the meter that holds the wall together.

Key decisions.

1. How to answer the residents who want to take the compensation.
2. Whether to accept a private offer from the developer.
3. How to respond to the threats against her family.
4. Day 7: form the human wall, negotiate better terms, or step aside.

Ending	Reached by	Verdict
As Written: The Iroko Still Stands	Forms the human wall	Lost the land, kept the community; she becomes elder to the displaced
Better Terms	Negotiates on Day 7	Kept more Naira for the residents, lost the community's unity
Silence	Steps aside	Lost both; Isale Eko scatters without a fight

No ending stops the demolition; this matches the book. An "Injunction" ending is listed as an open question.

6. Roots and Thorns — Emeka

A business chapter played in weekly turns as Innovate Africa's capital drains.

Loop. Each week: pay rent, salaries and generator diesel; then spend actions chasing the permit at Mrs. Balogun's office, pushing Baba Tunde on the port containers, hiring and keeping staff, or calling investors. Facilitation offers appear as Lagos Factor cards. Mama Ngozi visits between weeks with food and advice, and her scar is the quiet reminder of what the city takes.

Key decisions.

1. Refuse or pay the permit facilitation.
2. Refuse or pay the port "settlement" (half the container value).
3. What to tell investors, his mother and his London friends.

4. Whether to keep Chike by finding him more money.
5. Final choice: return to London, pay and launch, use a middleman, or stay and restart small.

Ending	Reached by	Verdict
As Written: Too Thorny	Calls his London boss	Kept Spirit, lost the dream; flies back to London
Lagos Factor	Pays the bribes	Kept the company, lost the reason he came
The Middleman	Lets an agent "handle" the payments	Kept the company and deniability; the guilt is his alone
Small Roots	Restarts small with no bribes	Kept Spirit and the dream, barely; Naira near zero

7. The Fabric of Dreams — Kosi

A design chapter: make the collection Chief Mrs. Adeleke demands by day and the real Kosi Kosi collection by night.

Loop. Day design rounds: choose fabric, palette and silhouette for each gala piece; Chief Mrs. Adeleke approves or tears pieces apart, trading Vision for Naira. Night rounds: build the secret collection between power cuts with apprentices after Baba Segun falls ill. Design-theft events reward documenting your work with photos and timestamps.

Key decisions.

1. How much to concede on each gala piece.
2. Whether to document every sketch (costs time, protects you later).
3. How to use Amara's plan for the secret collection.
4. At the gala: the brooch, a public exposé, stay silent, or walk out before the show.

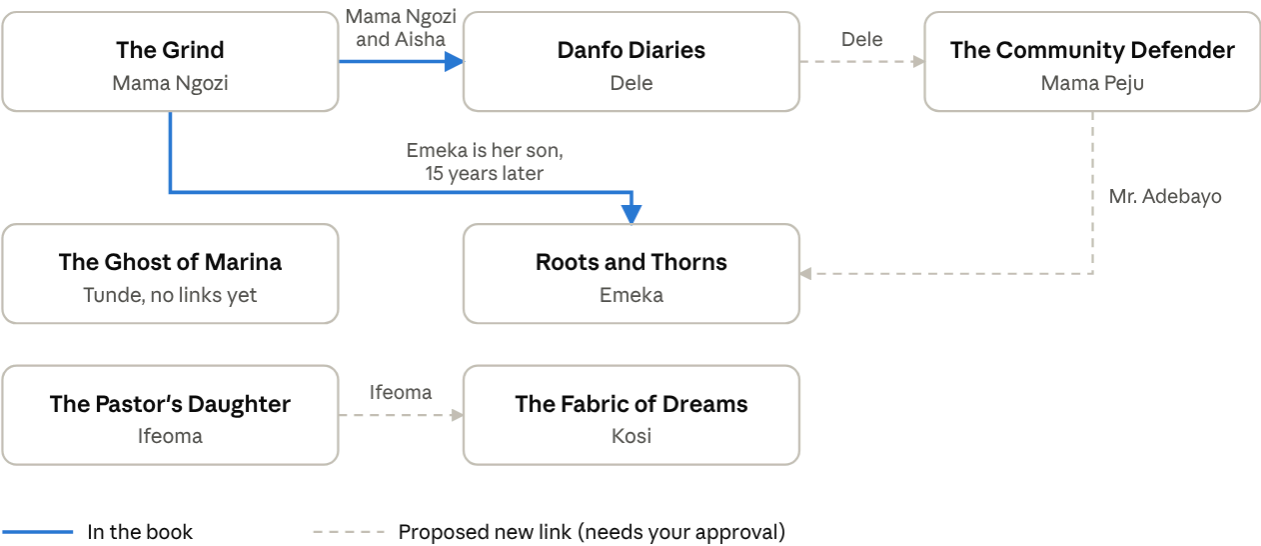
Ending	Reached by	Verdict
As Written: Kosi Kosi Has Arrived	The brooch, with documented work and Amara's viewing	Kept both; headlines Lagos Fashion Week
Assisted By	Stays silent	Kept the money, lost her name
Runway Scandal	Public exposé without documentation	Lost both; labelled difficult and frozen out

Ending	Reached by	Verdict
Walk Out	Leaves before the gala	Kept Spirit, lost the moment; starts again small

Crossover web

Two character links come straight from the revised manuscript; three more are proposed to make the city feel connected, and need your approval.

Two links come from the book; three are proposed



crossover web · 2 links from the book, 3 proposed

Arrows point from the earlier chapter to the later one it affects. The Ghost of Marina has no link yet.

Links and what they change

Link	Source	What happens in the game	Flag carried
The Grind → Danfo Diaries	Book	Mama Ngozi and Aisha appear at Iddo. If she was stabbed, she carries the scar; if she moved to Mile 12, Aisha shouts alone; if the market stood, more traders join the crowd and Dele's Solidarity starts higher.	ngozi_outcome

Link	Source	What happens in the game	Flag carried
The Grind → Roots and Thorns	Book	Emeka is her son, 15 years later. His backstory line and Mama Ngozi's visits change with The Grind's ending (for example, whether she still bears the scar or lost her Oshodi spot).	ngozi_outcome
Danfo Diaries → The Community Defender	Proposed	Dele's danfo carries displaced Isale Eko residents after the demolition. If Dele defied Bala, he refuses their fares.	dele_outcome
The Community Defender → Roots and Thorns	Proposed	Mr. Adebayo, the lawyer, is the one honest adviser Emeka meets; his advice opens the "Small Roots" ending.	peju_outcome
The Pastor's Daughter → The Fabric of Dreams	Proposed	Ifeoma, now in Surulere, is Kosi's customer, then a model for the secret collection.	ifeoma_outcome

Flag values are the ending IDs from Chapter designs (for example ngozi_outcome = as_written). A chapter played with no earlier save uses its As Written values.

Art, audio and UX

The game reads like an illustrated book come alive: text first, with still illustrations, ambient Lagos sound and a few interactive mini-scenes per chapter.

Visual direction

- **Style:** flat, hand-drawn illustration with bold colour, inspired by ankara and adire patterns. Each chapter gets one signature colour: Grind (palm-oil orange), Marina (lagoon steel blue), Pastor's Daughter (gold lace), Danfo (danfo yellow and black), Defender (adire indigo), Roots (Apapa rust), Fabric (vivid ankara magenta).
- **Asset count (first release):** one map, seven chapter covers, 4–6 scene stills per chapter (about 40 total), 15–20 character portraits with 2–3 expressions each, UI icons.

- **Typography:** a serif for narration (matching the book) and a bold sans-serif for UI, meters and the narrator's call.

Audio

- Ambient loops per location: Oshodi market, Marina office hum, church choir, Agege motor park, Isale Eko streets, Apapa port, Surulere workshop.
- Short stingers for meter changes, Lagos Factor cards and endings.
- Narrator voice for "Story, story!" and "Once upon a time..." only, recorded once and reused; full voice acting is out of scope for the first release.

Screen flow

1. Title and age gate.
2. Lagos map hub.
3. Chapter card (content note, endings found, Play).
4. Storytime opening (call and response).
5. Story screen: illustration on top, narration below, choices as buttons, meters in a slim top bar.
6. Mini-scenes where the chapter calls for them (frying, making change, ledger, design rounds).
7. Ending and verdict screen, then the Endings gallery.

Accessibility

- Adjustable text size and line spacing; dyslexia-friendly font option.
- Full keyboard and screen-reader support for every choice.
- No timed choice without a "relaxed timing" setting.
- Pidgin glossary: tap any underlined Pidgin phrase to see its meaning, without rewriting the dialogue.
- Colour is never the only way a meter or state is shown.

Technical architecture

Build a static web app with Vite, React and TypeScript; write each chapter's branching story in Ink; host on GitHub Pages; add PWA support; and wrap the same build for app stores later.

Stack

Layer	Choice	Why
Language and UI	TypeScript + React, built with Vite	Fast to build, well supported by Claude Code
Story scripting	Ink (by inkle), run in the browser with inkjs	Built for branching narrative; you can write and edit chapter scripts as text without touching code
Game state	A small store (Zustand) for meters, flags and progress	Simple, testable
Saves	IndexedDB (via a wrapper such as idb-keyval), with export and import of a save file	Works offline; survives refreshes
PWA	vite-plugin-pwa (manifest + service worker)	Installable on phone and desktop, works offline
Audio	Howler.js	Reliable web audio on mobile
Hosting	GitHub Pages, deployed by GitHub Actions on every push to <code>main</code>	Free, tied to your repo
App stores (later)	Capacitor to wrap the build for Android and iOS; or a Trusted Web Activity for Google Play	One codebase for web and stores
Testing	Vitest for logic; Playwright for playing through each chapter automatically	Catches broken branches

Check the current version of each library when setting up the repo.

How a chapter runs

The Ink script holds the story text, choices and the logic for meters and endings. The React app shows the text, illustrations and choices, runs the mini-scenes, and listens to Ink variables to update the meter bar. Cross-chapter flags (for example `ngozi_outcome`) are saved by the app when a chapter ends and passed into the next chapter's Ink story when it starts.

```
// chapters/01-the-grind.ink (excerpt)
VAR naira = 50
VAR spirit = 60
VAR profit = 0
VAR solidarity = 0

=== confrontation ===
"So, Mama? Your five hundred naira ready?"
* [Pay the ₦500]
  ~ naira -= 30
  ~ spirit -= 20
  -> ending_paid_in_full
* [Stand on your dignity]
  ~ spirit += 20
  -> ending_as_written
* {solidarity >= 3} [Call the traders to stand with you]
  -> ending_market_stands
```

Repository layout

storytime-lagos/	
.github/workflows/deploy.yml	build and publish to GitHub Pages
CLAUDE.md	project rules for Claude Code
docs/	this design document, exported as Markdown
chapters/	one .ink file per chapter + shared.ink
src/	
engine/	Ink runner, meters, flags, saves
scenes/	mini-scenes (frying, change-making, ledger,
design rounds)	
ui/	map hub, story screen, endings gallery,
settings	
content/	chapter metadata, glossary, Lagos Factor
cards (JSON)	
public/	
art/	assets and PWA icons
audio/	
icons/	
tests/	unit tests and Playwright playthroughs

Data kept per player

Data	Example	Stored
Progress	Chapters unlocked and finished	IndexedDB

Data	Example	Stored
Endings found	<code>grind.as_written,</code> <code>danfo.empty_hands</code>	IndexedDB
Cross-chapter flags	<code>ngozi_outcome = stabbed</code>	IndexedDB
Current save	Chapter, Ink state, meters	IndexedDB, exportable as a file
Settings	Text size, relaxed timing, audio	localStorage

No accounts or servers are needed for the first release; everything lives on the player's device.

Book companion and marketing

The game's job is to send players to the book and give readers a reason to play; every hook below supports one of those two directions.

Game to book

- **As Written badge:** each canon ending shows a book icon and the line "This is how it ends in *What Is It About Lagos*" with a link to buy.
- **Chapter 1 free:** *The Grind* is always free to play on the web as the demo.
- **Store links** on the title screen, ending screens and the Endings gallery.
- **Shareable verdict cards:** after each chapter, a share image ("I kept my Spirit and lost my Naira in Oshodi") with the game link and book title, sized for WhatsApp status, Instagram and X.

Book to game

- **QR code in the book:** one page at the end of each story with a QR code that opens that chapter in the game.
- **Reader unlock code:** a code printed in the book unlocks bonus content: author's notes per chapter, early sketches, and the "Lagos Remembers" epilogue before finishing all seven chapters.
- **Back-of-book page** describing the game.

Unlock model options (decision needed)

Option	How it works	Trade-off
A. Fully free, book sells itself	All 7 chapters free; book links everywhere	Widest reach, no direct game income
B. Chapter 1 free, code unlocks the rest	Book buyers get a code; others can buy a code	Rewards readers, smaller audience for chapters 2–7
C. Free game, paid bonus pack	All chapters free; author's notes and epilogue need the book's code	Wide reach plus a reason to buy the book

Option C is the recommended default: it keeps the game open while giving the book a clear extra.

Launch checklist

- ☐ Landing page for the game and the book, sharing one domain
- ☐ Trailer: 30–60 seconds of the Storytime opening and map
- ☐ Short clips for TikTok and Instagram Reels from each chapter's key decision
- ☐ Book launch and game launch on the same week

Build roadmap

Build one complete, polished chapter first (The Grind), then add the other six on the same engine; each milestone ends with something you can play in a browser.

1. **M0 — Repo and shell.** Create the GitHub repo, the Vite + React + TypeScript app, the GitHub Pages deploy workflow and the PWA manifest.
 - Done when: an empty "STORYTIME" title screen is live on your GitHub Pages link and installs on your phone.
 - Claude Code prompt: *"Set up a Vite React TypeScript app called storytime-lagos with vite-plugin-pwa and a GitHub Actions workflow that deploys to GitHub Pages. Follow CLAUDE.md."*
2. **M1 — Story engine.** Ink runner, meters bar, choice buttons, save and load, settings.
 - Done when: a 5-choice test story plays, meters move, and progress survives a refresh.
3. **M2 — The Grind, playable.** Full chapter script in Ink, the frying and change-making mini-scenes, all 4 endings, the Storytime opening.

- Done when: you can reach all 4 endings, and an automated playthrough test reaches each one.
- 4. **M3 — Map hub and endings gallery.** Lagos map, chapter cards, unlock rules, verdict screen, share card.
 - Done when: finishing The Grind unlocks Ghost of Marina on the map.
- 5. **M4 — Chapters 2–4.** Ghost of Marina (ledger puzzle), Pastor's Daughter (weekly cycle), Danfo Diaries (route runs and change-making), with the Mama Ngozi crossover.
- 6. **M5 — Chapters 5–7.** Community Defender (7-day strategy), Roots and Thorns (weekly business turns), Fabric of Dreams (design rounds), with the Emeka crossover.
- 7. **M6 — Art, audio and polish.** Final illustrations, ambient audio, accessibility pass, content notes, age gate.
- 8. **M7 — Companion features and launch.** QR deep links per chapter, reader unlock code, landing page, analytics if wanted.
- 9. **M8 — App stores (optional).** Wrap with Capacitor; complete store listings and age ratings.

Working with Claude Code

- Keep each request to one milestone step; ask Claude Code to run the tests before it finishes.
- Write the chapter scripts in `chapters/*.ink` yourself or with Claude; keep code changes and story changes in separate commits.
- Save this design document into `docs/` so Claude Code can read it.

Starter CLAUDE.md

```
# STORYTIME: Lagos
```

```
Narrative choice game, companion to the book "What Is It About Lagos".
Design doc: docs/design.md. Read it before changing game rules.
```

```
## Stack
```

- Vite + React + TypeScript, Zustand for state
- Ink chapter scripts in chapters/, run with inkjs
- vite-plugin-pwa; deployed to GitHub Pages by .github/workflows/deploy.yml

```
## Rules
```

- Story text lives only in chapters/*.ink. Never hard-code story text in React.
- Keep Nigerian Pidgin dialogue exactly as written; add glossary entries in src/content/glossary.json.
- Meters are 0-100: naira, spirit, and one chapter meter.
- Cross-chapter flags are saved at chapter end and passed in at chapter start.
- Every ending must be reachable by a Playwright test in tests/.
- Run `npm test` and `npm run build` before finishing any task.

Open questions

These decisions change what gets built; each needs your answer before its milestone starts.

- ☐ **Alternate endings:** approve, change or cut each proposed alternate ending in Chapter designs (before M2 for The Grind, before M4–M5 for the rest).
- ☐ **Unlock model:** A, B or C in Book companion and marketing (before M7).
- ☐ **Injunction ending:** should Isale Eko be able to win, if Morale and media pressure are both very high? The book says no (before M5).
- ☐ **New crossover cameos:** approve or cut the proposed links marked "new" in the Crossover web (before M4).
- ☐ **Art:** commission an illustrator, or make art yourself or with tools; and budget (before M6).
- ☐ **Narrator voice:** record your own voice for "Story, story!", or hire a voice actor (before M6).
- ☐ **Distribution:** global or regional store listings, and legal advice on Nigerian distribution of The Pastor's Daughter chapter (before M8).

- ☐ **Analytics:** track which endings players reach (privacy-friendly, no accounts), or none (before M7).
- ☐ **Book title in the game:** confirm the final published title of the book and the store links (before M7).